

Module 3 - Indian Religion, Philosophy and Practices

(Edushine Classes)

🌸 What is Religion? (धर्म क्या है?)

👉 **Religion** means:

- A system of **beliefs** and **practices** followed by people.
- It tells us **what is right and wrong, how to live life, and how to connect with God.**
- Religion gives **rules for living, worship, rituals, and moral values.**

✦ **Simple Definition:**

Religion is a way to live life with discipline, goodness, and belief in a higher power.

✓ **Pre-Vedic Religion** (Before Vedas came)

👉 **What it was like:**

- This was the **religion of early tribes** before the Vedas were written.
- People lived close to **nature**, so they **worshipped natural forces** like:
 - Sun ☀️
 - Moon 🌙
 - Water 💧
 - Trees 🌳
 - Fire 🔥
- They believed nature has **divine power.**

✦ **Features:**

- **No temples or idols** — worship was done in open nature.
- **No written texts** — only oral traditions.
- Simple rituals like singing and dancing to thank nature.

✦ **Trick to Remember:**

👉 Pre-Vedic = **Nature Worship**

(They saw God in trees, rivers, sun, etc.)

✓ Vedic Religion (Based on Vedas)

This came after the Pre-Vedic period when **Vedas were written**.

📖 What are the Vedas?

- Vedas = oldest holy books of India (written in Sanskrit)
- 4 types: **Rigveda, Samaveda, Yajurveda, Atharvaveda**

🔥 Features of Vedic Religion:

1. **Gods and Devas** were worshipped like:
 - **Indra** (rain & thunder god)
 - **Agni** (fire god)
 - **Varuna** (water god)
2. **Yajnas (fire rituals)** were important.
3. Prayers were chanted in **Sanskrit**.
4. **Priests (Brahmins)** became important in society.

✈ Trick to Remember:

📖 Vedic Religion = **Fire Worship + Vedas + Gods**

Point	Pre-Vedic Religion	Vedic Religion
Time	Before Vedas	After Vedas were written
Worship Style	Nature Worship	Fire rituals (Yajnas)
Gods Worshipped	Nature (Sun, Moon, Water)	Devas like Indra, Agni
Scriptures	None (oral)	4 Vedas (written in Sanskrit)
Priests	Not specific	Brahmins played key role
Rituals	Simple	Organized with chants

📖 Buddhism (In Easy Words)

🌟 Founder: Gautam Buddha

- Real name: **Siddhartha Gautama**
- Born in **Lumbini** (in present-day Nepal)
- His father: **Shuddhodhan**, king of the **Shakya** clan

- Mother: **Maya Devi**
 - He was born in a **royal family**, but gave up all luxuries to find peace and truth
-

Life of Gautam Buddha (Easy Summary):

- When he saw **old age, sickness, and death**, he became very sad and wanted to know the truth of life.
 - At **age 29**, he **left his palace** secretly (this is called *Mahabhinishkraman* = great renunciation).
 - He started living like a **monk** and did **meditation** for many years.
 - At **age 35**, he got **enlightenment** (ultimate knowledge) under a **Bodhi tree** at **Bodh Gaya**.
 - After that, he became known as **Buddha** which means "**the enlightened one**".
-

Teachings of Buddha (Buddhism's Main Ideas)

Buddha taught in **simple and easy language** so that **common people** could understand.

✓ Four Noble Truths:

1. Life is full of **suffering (dukkha)**.
 2. Suffering is caused by **desires**.
 3. If we remove desires, **suffering will end**.
 4. Follow the **Eightfold Path** to remove desires and reach **peace (Nirvana)**.
-

Eightfold Path (Ashtangik Marg)

These are 8 right ways to live life:

1. Right Understanding
2. Right Thought
3. Right Speech
4. Right Action
5. Right Livelihood (job)

6. Right Effort
7. Right Mindfulness
8. Right Concentration

🧘 Learn these 8 things = You will live a good and peaceful life

🗺️ □ Spread of Buddhism

- Buddha gave sermons (teachings) for 45 years
- He traveled to many places to teach people
- His teachings were written in **Pali language** (simple local language)
- After his death, **his followers spread Buddhism to Sri Lanka, China, Japan, Tibet, and many other countries**

📖 What is Jainism? (In Easy Words)

- Jainism is an **ancient Indian religion**.
 - It was **founded by Rishabhdev Ji** (1st Tirthankara), but the real founder of Jainism as a movement was **Mahavira** (24th Tirthankara).
 - Mahavira was born in **Bihar** around 599 BCE.
 - He left his home at age 30 and practiced deep meditation.
 - After 12 years, he got **keval gyan** (pure knowledge) and became a **Tirthankara**.
 - Jainism teaches **peace, non-violence, and simple living**.
-

★ Main Principles of Jainism (5 Big Rules)

These are called **Pancha Mahavrata** (5 Great Vows):

1. **Ahimsa (Non-violence)** – Don't hurt any living being (even insects or plants).
2. **Satya (Truth)** – Always speak the truth.
3. **Asteya (No stealing)** – Don't take anything without permission.
4. **Brahmacharya (Celibacy)** – Control over desires.
5. **Aparigraha (Non-possessiveness)** – Don't be greedy or attached to money/things.

🏠 *These are the main rules followed by monks. Common people follow smaller versions called **Anuvrata**.*

Types of Vrats (Vows) in Jainism

1. Anuvrata (for common people):

These are small versions of the 5 main rules:

- Less strict than monks
- Easy to follow in normal life

2. Mahavrata (for monks/sadhus):

- Very strict rules
- Monks follow them for **moksha (liberation)**

Other Vows (For Better Living):

3. Guna Vrat (3 vows to control behavior):

1. Digvrata – Limit the direction you go
2. Bhog-Upbhog Vrat – Limit food and things you enjoy
3. Anartha-dand Vrat – Avoid useless or harmful activities

4. Shiksha Vrat (2 learning vows):

1. Samayik – Practice calmness and equality for 48 minutes
2. Desavakasika – Limit work to certain places/time

Goal of Jainism:

- The main aim is to **achieve moksha** (freedom from the cycle of birth and death).
- Moksha is possible by following the **right path, right knowledge, and right conduct** (this is called *Triratna*).

Easy Trick to Remember:

"Ahimsa-Satya-Asteya-Brahmacharya-Aparigraha" = 5 Big Rules

"Anuvrata-Mahavrata-Gunavrata-Shikshavrat" = 4 Types of Vows

📖 What are the Six Systems of Indian Philosophy?

The relational investigation of question about existence, Knowledge, and ethics is called Philosophy. These are **six ways of thinking about life, truth, soul, and the universe**, developed in ancient India. They are:

1. Nyaya (न्याय) – *Logic and Reasoning*

- Focus: Logical thinking and debate
- Believes in using **proofs and arguments** to understand truth.
- Example: Like a court where everything is proved with logic and evidence.

🔑 Keywords: Reasoning, logic, proof, debate

2. Vaisheshika (वैशेषिक) – *Atomic Theory & Science*

- Focus: Everything is made of **atoms (anu)**.
- Talks about **matter, motion, and time**.
- Example: Like science class – studies natural things using categories.

🔑 Keywords: Atoms, time, space, physical world

3. Sankhya (सांख्य) – *Numbers & Dualism*

- Focus: Two realities – **Purusha (soul)** and **Prakriti (nature)**.
- Says that **liberation (moksha)** happens when soul separates from matter.
- Example: Like body is machine (Prakriti), and driver is soul (Purusha).

🔑 Keywords: Dualism, soul vs nature, balance

4. Yoga (योग) – *Discipline & Meditation*

- Based on Sankhya system.
- Focus: Controlling body and mind through **asanas**, **meditation**, and **breathing (pranayama)**.
- Example: Like doing yoga to stay calm and focused, and get closer to moksha.

👉 Keywords: Meditation, self-control, spiritual path

5. Mimamsa (मीमांसा) – *Rituals & Vedas*

- Focus: Following **Vedic rituals** and duties correctly.
- Believes that doing proper **karma (action)** leads to a good life.
- Example: Like doing puja or havan perfectly brings good results.

👉 Keywords: Vedas, rituals, dharma, karma

6. Vedanta (वेदान्त) – *Ultimate Knowledge & Moksha*

- Focus: Teachings from **Upanishads**.
- Believes in **one supreme soul (Brahman)**.
- Says everything is part of one divine power, and goal is to **realize the self (Atma = Brahman)**.
- Example: Like realizing you are not just a drop of water but part of the ocean.

👉 Keywords: Brahman, atma, moksha, Upanishads

🔗 [Easy Trick to Remember \(Mnemonic\):](#)

"Nice Veg Samosa Makes You Very Happy"

- **N** – Nyaya
- **V** – Vaisheshika
- **S** – Sankhya
- **M** – Mimamsa

- **Y** – Yoga
- **V** – Vedanta

🔗 Who was Adi Shankaracharya?

Adi Shankaracharya was a **great Indian saint, philosopher, and reformer**. He lived around **788–820 CE** and helped revive **Hinduism** at a time when it was losing strength due to confusion, superstitions, and other faiths.

📖 Key Points about Adi Shankaracharya:

1. Jagadguru (World Teacher)

- The word "Jagadguru" means **teacher of the world**.
 - He was called so because he traveled across India to **spread knowledge and unite people**.
-

2. Advaita Vedanta Philosophy

- He taught **Advaita Vedanta**, which means:
 - "**Advaita**" = *Not two* → Everything is **One**.
 - **Atma (soul)** and **Brahman (God)** are the **same**.
 - We all are **not separate** from God.
 - Example: Just like all rivers merge into one ocean, all souls are one with Brahman.
-

3. Mission: Unity and Reform

- He **removed superstitions** and blind rituals.
 - He said: "**Knowledge is the real worship.**"
 - Fought against meaningless caste discrimination.
-

4. Travelled All Over India

- By the age of 32, he **traveled the whole country** by foot!

- Debated with scholars and **united Hindus** through knowledge.
-

5. Founded 4 Mathas (Peeths)

- Established **4 major religious centers (mathas)** in:
 - **North** – Badrinath (Uttarakhand)
 - **South** – Sringeri (Karnataka)
 - **East** – Puri (Odisha)
 - **West** – Dwaraka (Gujarat)
 - These still teach **Sanatan Dharma** today.
-

6. Wrote Many Books

- Wrote commentaries on:
 - **Bhagavad Gita**
 - **Upanishads**
 - **Brahma Sutras**
 - Also wrote **prayers** like *Bhaja Govindam*, *Atma Bodha*, etc.
-



His Famous Teaching:

"Brahma Satyam, Jagat Mithya, Jivo Brahmaiva Na Parah"

"Brahman is truth, the world is an illusion, and the self is not different from Brahman."



What is the Bhakti Movement?

The **Bhakti Movement** was a **religious and social movement** in India that began around the **7th century in South India** and later spread across the country (mainly in the **15th to 17th century**).

It focused on **love and devotion (bhakti)** to **one God**, and **rejected caste, rituals, and inequality**.

🔍 Why did the Bhakti Movement Start? (Reasons)

1. ✅ **Social Problems**
 - People were **divided by caste system**.
 - Lower castes were **disrespected** and not allowed in temples.
2. 🧑🧑 **Too Many Rituals**
 - Religion had become full of **complicated pujas and rules**, and common people were confused.
3. 🤝 **Need for Unity**
 - India was facing invasions and divisions. Bhakti saints wanted to **unite people through love for God**.
4. 🕌 **Rise of Islam**
 - Islam taught equality and devotion to one God. This also **inspired Hindu saints** to spread a **similar path of love and devotion**.

🎯 Objectives of Bhakti Movement

- ❤️ Teach **devotion (bhakti)** to **one God**.
- 🧑🧑🧑🧑 Treat **everyone equally**, no matter the **caste or gender**.
- 🛑 Stop **idol worship, rituals, and blind beliefs**.
- 🔊 Spread teachings in **simple local language** so that **everyone can understand**.
- ✨ Focus on **inner purity, love, and peace**.

👑 Famous Bhakti Saints

Region	Saint Name	God Worshipped
South India	Alvars & Nayanars	Vishnu & Shiva
Maharashtra	Sant Tukaram, Sant Dnyaneshwar	Vithoba
North India	Kabir Das	Nirguna (God without form)
North India	Guru Nanak Dev Ji	One Supreme God
North India	Meera Bai	Lord Krishna
East India	Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	Krishna

Impact of Bhakti Movement

1.  **Unity and Brotherhood**
 - Brought **Hindus and Muslims** closer through shared values.
2.  **Opposed Caste Discrimination**
 - Saints like Kabir and Ravidas taught that **God lives in every heart**, not in caste.
3.  **Boosted Local Languages**
 - Bhakti saints used **Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, Bengali** instead of Sanskrit, so **common people could understand**.
4.   **Spiritual Awakening**
 - People learned that **love for God is more important than rituals**.
5.  **Bhajans and Poems**
 - Saints wrote **beautiful songs, poetry, and bhajans** that are still sung today.

In Simple Words:

The **Bhakti Movement** was like a **revolution of love**. It said:
“**Love God with your heart, treat others with kindness. Forget caste, rituals, and hate. All are equal before God.**”

What is the Sufi Movement?

The **Sufi Movement** was a **spiritual movement in Islam** that focused on **love for God, kindness, peace, and helping others**.

Just like Bhakti saints, Sufi saints also **rejected religious rituals and focused on the heart and soul**.

✦ **Sufi = Pyar aur Shanti ka raasta (Path of Love and Peace)**

When and Where It Started?

- Started in **8th-9th century** in **Arab countries**, but came to **India around 11th century**.
- Sufi saints are also called "**Peers**" or "**Fakirs**" in India.

♥ Main Teachings of Sufism (Very Simple)

Sufi Belief	Easy Explanation
Love of God	True love is only for one God.
All Humans are One	No difference between Hindu-Muslim, rich-poor.
Service to People	Helping others is like serving God.
Inner Purity	Clean heart is more important than outer rituals.
Simple Living	Live a simple and honest life.

★ Famous Sufi Saints in India

Saint Name	Known For	Area
Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti	Ajmer Dargah, preached love	Rajasthan
Nizamuddin Auliya	Taught universal brotherhood	Delhi
Baba Farid	Spread teachings in Punjabi	Punjab
Sheikh Salim Chishti	Respected by Akbar	Fatehpur Sikri

🎯 Objectives of the Sufi Movement

- Spread **peace, love, and unity** among people.
 - Reduce hatred between **Hindus and Muslims**.
 - Focus on **personal relationship with God**, not rituals.
 - Encourage **music (Qawwali)** and **poetry** to remember God.
-

🎵 Sufi Music – Qawwali

Sufis used **Qawwali (songs about love for God)** to spread their message.
Famous qawwals like **Amir Khusro** made Sufi poetry popular.

Impact of the Sufi Movement

1.  **Unity Between Religions**
 - Helped in **Hindu-Muslim unity** like the Bhakti movement.
2.  **Dargahs (Tombs of Sufi Saints)**
 - Became places of **worship and peace** for all communities.
3.  **Spread of Islam in India**
 - Many people accepted Islam due to the **loving nature** of Sufis.
4.  **Growth of Music & Poetry**
 - Encouraged Qawwalis and spiritual poetry (Sufi literature).

Trick to Remember:

"**Sufi means Sofi dil (soft heart)** – love God, love all, help others, no hate."

Bhakti Movement	Sufi Movement
Hindu-based	Islam-based
Saints: Kabir, Meera, Namdev	Saints: Moinuddin, Nizamuddin
Focus on Bhakti (devotion)	Focus on Ishq-e-Haqiqi (divine love)
Against caste	Against religious hatred

What is Modern Religious Practices?

- **Religion** has always been a big part of **Indian culture and life**.
- Even today, most people follow religion in one form or another.
- According to the **2011 census**, these are the major religions in India:

Religion	Percentage of people
Hinduism	79.8%
Islam	14.2%
Christianity	2.3%
Sikhism	1.7%
Buddhism	0.7%
Jainism	0.37%

? Details about Major Religions (in easy words)

1. Hinduism

- Most common religion in India.
- Has many gods and beliefs.
- Includes traditions like worship, festivals, temples, and yoga.

2. Islam

- Second most followed religion in India.
- Followers are called **Muslims**.
- Believe in **one God (Allah)** and follow the teachings of **Prophet Muhammad**.

3. Sikhism

- Started in **Punjab**.
- Teaches **equality, hard work, prayer, and helping others** (Seva).
- Holy book: **Guru Granth Sahib**.

4. Buddhism

- Based on the teachings of **Gautama Buddha**.
- Focuses on **peace, meditation, and removing suffering**.

5. Jainism

- Believes in **Ahimsa** (non-violence).
- Promotes **vegetarianism, kindness, and animal protection**.

6. Christianity

- Follows the teachings of **Jesus Christ**.
 - Mostly followed in **South India** and **Mumbai**.
 - Holy book: **Bible**.
-

★ **Final Tip to Remember:**

India is a land of unity in diversity, where people of different religions live together and follow their own paths peacefully.